



Civic Meeting Report

03-12-2024 MCS Board Meeting

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=j3iO_7majsE
Publication Date	2024-03-13T10:08:40Z
Target Category	mcs

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Community Meeting Report: Muncie Community Schools Board of Education

Meeting Date: March 12, 2024

Document Type: Comprehensive Civic Meeting Summary

Analyst: Expert Civic Analyst

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** [00:06:46](#) The regular board meeting of the Muncie Community Schools (MCS) Board of Education was called to order on March 12, 2024, by presiding officer Jim (Board President).
- **Attendance:**
 - **Present:** Dr. O'Neal, Mr. Heeter, Mrs. Barres Griffin, Mr. Irvin, Mr. Low (Presiding officer Jim also noted throughout).
 - **Absent:** None noted.
 - **Presiding Officer:** Jim (Board President).

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** 00:06:49 The meeting opened with a moment of silence, followed by the recitation of the Pledge of Allegiance led by student representatives 00:07:29.
 - **Approval of Minutes:** *Not explicitly detailed in the transcript snippet.*
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4. Substantive Business & Board Action

00:08:07 East Washington Academy (EWA) School Report & Student Recognition

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Evan (Principal of East Washington Academy) alongside students and staff.
- **Deliberation Summary:** Principal Evan presented an overview of EWA's academic, behavioral, and extracurricular successes. Highlights included the school's PBIS (Positive Behavioral Interventions and Supports) initiative centered on four core values (Courage, Integrity, Compassion, Perseverance), rising attendance trends (targeting an increase from 91.35% to 95%), decreasing behavior incidents through early intervention, and strong reading/math growth. Special emphasis was placed on the success of the science of reading approach (CKLA curriculum) and targeted interventions using mClass Dibbles.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Information presentation only; no formal board action required.

00:38:28 Consent Agenda (Personnel / Retirement)

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Jim (Board President) / Administration.
- **Deliberation Summary:** The board reviewed the consent agenda, specifically recognizing the retirement of Linda Black, Adult Education Record Specialist at the Area Career Center, who served 31 years with MCS.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote 00:39:05.

00:39:10 Financial Report

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Durham (Chief Financial Officer).
- **Deliberation Summary:** Mr. Durham presented the February financial results. Key metrics included:
 - Receipt of the state basic grant, expecting a total of slightly over \$47 million for the calendar year based on an enrollment count of 4,938 students in February 2023/2024 (down only 13 students since October 2023).
 - Overall checkbook balance at the end of February at nearly \$32 million.
 - Education fund cash balance projected at nearly \$15 million by December.

- State loan down to \$9.6 million, continuing paydowns of over \$150,000 per month through 2028.
- Operations fund continues to be a point of budgetary concern, utilizing rainy day funds to offset spending.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote [00:42:07](#).

[00:42:12 Muncie Virtual Academy Reorganization](#)

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Administration / Mr. Durham.
- **Deliberation Summary:** Proposal to transition the Muncie Virtual Academy back from an independent school designation under state metrics to a standard program housed within each individual school building. Enrollment had dropped below the statutory threshold of 100 students for much of the year. Moving back to a program model allows virtual students better access to student support services, family navigators, and assistant coordinators at their home schools.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote [00:43:29](#).

[00:43:35 Personnel Action: Superintendent Retirement & Succession Planning](#)

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Jim (Board President), Dr. Lee Ann Kwiatkowski (Superintendent), and Dr. Chuck Reynolds.
- **Deliberation Summary:** Dr. Lee Ann Kwiatkowski announced her retirement as Superintendent, effective June 30, 2024, after five years of leadership. The board expressed deep gratitude for her service, navigation of the COVID-19 pandemic, fiscal stabilization, and academic growth. Concurrently, the board announced the planned succession of Dr. Chuck Reynolds as the incoming Superintendent, effective July 1, 2024, fulfilling the leadership transition plan established in 2019. Board members shared extensive remarks praising both outgoing and incoming leadership.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion to accept Dr. Kwiatkowski's retirement effective June 30, 2024, and approve the hiring of Dr. Reynolds as Superintendent effective July 1, 2024. Approved by Voice Vote [01:00:27](#).

5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- *No open public comment period or general citizen forum occurred during this meeting.*
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6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - Dr. Kwiatkowski reported that the Indiana Department of Education (IDOE) onsite monitoring audit visit is scheduled for the following day, involving multiple school sites and fiscal staff reviews 00:36:43.
 - Book vending machines (funded by the George and Frances Ball Foundation and local efforts) are being successfully rolled out across elementary schools, rewarding student attendance, behavior, and academic growth with books to keep 00:35:06.
 - **Adjournment:** 00:06:51 (Meeting start) / 01:06:36 (Adjournment motion). The meeting was officially adjourned by voice vote.
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